



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Senior Deck Officers Adaptation & Refreshment Training

Command-level refreshment on passage planning oversight, cargo operations, crisis management and mentoring for Masters and Chief Officers aboard a Glory Ship Management vessel.

SOLAS Ch. V

STCW Reg. II/2

ISM Code

Company SMS

What We Will Cover

01

Role & Responsibilities of the Senior Deck Officer

What sets Master and Chief Officer accountability apart

02

Passage Planning Oversight & Voyage Management

Approving, monitoring and owning every passage the ship makes

03

Cargo Operations Oversight

Stability, stowage and the Chief Officer's overall responsibility

04

Emergency Command & Crisis Management

Taking command and managing a developing emergency

05

Leadership & Mentoring Junior Officers

Building the bridge team and the officers who replace you

06

External Inspections — PSC, Vetting & Audits

Standing ready for Port State Control, vetting and audits

07

SMS & Regulatory Compliance Refresher

Your personal accountability under the ISM Code



SECTION 1

Role & Responsibilities of the Senior Deck Officer

What distinguishes command-level accountability from watchkeeping duty, and how the master and chief officer's roles divide and overlap.

01

Authority and Accountability at Command Level

The master's authority under SOLAS and the ISM Code is unique aboard ship — and it comes with matching accountability.

- The master holds overriding authority and responsibility to make decisions on safety, security and marine environment protection, and to request Company assistance as necessary.
- The Company must not constrain the master's authority to take any decision which, in their professional judgement, is necessary for safety of life at sea or protection of the environment.
- The chief officer is the master's principal deputy, directly responsible for cargo operations, stability, deck department management and safety equipment maintenance.
- Both roles carry personal legal exposure — under flag state law, port state control and in some jurisdictions criminal liability — that increases with seniority.
- Command-level officers are expected to exercise independent professional judgement, not merely follow checklists — checklists support the judgement, they do not replace it.



Overriding Authority

No commercial pressure — charterer, agent or even the Company itself — may override the master's professional judgement on matters of safety, security or the environment.

DIVISION OF RESPONSIBILITY

Master and Chief Officer — Complementary Roles

While the master holds overall command, day-to-day execution is distributed across the senior deck team.



Master

Overall command, final authority on navigation and safety decisions, external representation of the ship and the Company.



Chief Officer

Cargo and stability, deck department supervision, safety equipment and the ship's overall maintenance standard.



Junior Officer Oversight

Ensuring junior officers are properly briefed, supervised and progressively given more independent responsibility.



Shared Accountability

Both master and chief officer answer to the Company's DPA and are jointly reviewed during internal audits and inspections.

Exercising Authority Effectively

Effective command authority is earned through consistency, not asserted through rank alone.



Do

- Set the standard by personal example in safety behaviour and professionalism
- Make decisions decisively once you have the information you need
- Explain the reasoning behind orders when time allows, to build the team's understanding
- Actively invite challenge and dissent from your bridge or deck team



Don't

- Don't let commercial pressure from charterers or agents override a safety decision
- Don't dismiss a junior officer's observation without hearing it out
- Don't rely on rank alone to enforce compliance — explain the 'why'
- Don't delay a difficult decision hoping the situation will resolve itself



SECTION 2

Passage Planning Oversight & Voyage Management

The master's non-delegable responsibility to approve, monitor and take ownership of every passage the ship makes.

02

The Master's Oversight of Passage Planning

Passage planning is delegated for preparation, never for final approval.

- SOLAS Chapter V, Regulation 34 requires a passage plan to be prepared for every voyage, covering berth to berth, and approved by the master before the voyage begins.
- The master's approval is a substantive review — of the route, UKC margins, contingency plans and no-go areas — not a signature of convenience.
- The appraisal, planning, execution and monitoring cycle set out in the IMO Guidelines must be visible in the plan, not just the plotted track.
- The master remains responsible for the plan's ongoing suitability throughout the voyage, adjusting it as weather, traffic or operational conditions change.
- A properly approved and monitored passage plan is one of the most heavily scrutinised documents during a grounding or collision investigation.



Approve, Don't Just Sign

A master's signature on a passage plan represents genuine, substantive review — an unreviewed plan offers no real defence in an incident investigation.

What Senior Officers Actively Monitor

Command-level oversight goes beyond the passage plan itself to the ongoing conduct of the voyage.



Weather Routeing

Reviewing weather routeing advice and adjusting the plan proactively for forecast deterioration, not reactively.



ETA & Charter Party Compliance

Balancing safe speed and fuel-efficient operation against charter party and commercial ETA commitments.



High-Risk Area Transits

Specific planning and Company approval for piracy high-risk areas, ice-affected waters or heavily congested traffic zones.



Bridge Team Briefing

Ensuring the whole bridge team, not just the OOW, understands the plan's critical points and contingencies.

PASSAGE PLAN STAGES

The Stages of Passage Planning

IMO guidelines structure every passage plan around the same core stages, at every level of seniority.

1

Appraisal — gathering all information relevant to the intended voyage

2

Planning — the detailed berth-to-berth plan, with contingencies and no-go areas

3

Monitoring — continuous execution and monitoring against the plan throughout the voyage



SECTION 3

Cargo Operations Oversight

Stability, stowage and the chief officer's overall responsibility for safe, efficient cargo operations.

03

Overall Responsibility for Cargo & Stability

Cargo operations are executed by the deck team but remain the chief officer's direct responsibility to the master.

- The chief officer approves the cargo/stowage plan and stability calculations before loading begins, checking against the approved stability booklet and securing manual.
- Loading, discharging and ballasting sequences are monitored throughout to keep stress, trim and stability within approved limits at every stage, not just at completion.
- Any cargo operation that would take the ship outside its approved stability or stress envelope is stopped and referred to the master and the Company's technical department.
- Special cargoes — dangerous goods, heavy lifts, project cargo — require additional planning, documentation and often direct chief officer supervision on deck.
- The chief officer verifies draft surveys, cargo documentation and any discrepancies before the mate's receipt or bill of lading is signed.



Never Guess Stability

When in doubt about a stability or stress calculation, stop cargo operations and verify with the loading computer and the ship's stability booklet — do not proceed on an assumption.

What the Chief Officer Actively Supervises

Cargo oversight spans planning, execution and documentation.



Stowage & Lashing

Approving stowage plans and verifying lashing/securing arrangements meet the Cargo Securing Manual requirements.



Stability & Stress Monitoring

Continuous use of the loading computer to confirm stability, trim and hull stress remain within approved limits.



Dangerous Goods Compliance

Verifying IMDG Code segregation, documentation and stowage requirements for any hazardous cargo carried.



Cargo Documentation

Reviewing draft surveys, mate's receipts, bills of lading and any letters of protest before signature.

Supervising Cargo Operations Safely

The chief officer's presence and attention during cargo operations sets the safety tone for the whole deck team.



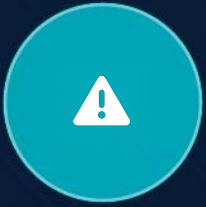
Do

- Verify the stability condition before and after every major loading/discharging stage
- Walk the deck regularly during cargo operations to check lashings and crew safety
- Stop operations immediately if stress or stability limits are approached
- Brief the duty officer fully before handing over supervision of ongoing cargo work



Don't

- Don't sign cargo documents you have not personally verified
- Don't allow loading to proceed faster than the ballast/stability plan supports
- Don't permit shortcuts in dangerous goods segregation for schedule pressure
- Don't leave cargo watch supervision to an under-briefed junior officer



SECTION 4

Emergency Command & Crisis Management

Taking command of a developing emergency and managing the ship, crew and Company response as it unfolds.

04

The Master's Role in an Emergency

In an emergency, the master's command role shifts from oversight to direct, active leadership.

- The master takes direct command of the ship's response, activating the muster list and the ship's emergency response procedures without delay.
- Early, accurate situation assessment — what has happened, current status, immediate risks — shapes every subsequent decision and must be continuously updated.
- The master declares the level of emergency and notifies the Company's DPA and, where relevant, the nearest RCC/MRCC, coast state or flag state as required.
- Command presence matters: a calm, decisive master stabilizes the whole crew's response, while visible panic or indecision degrades it rapidly.
- The chief officer typically takes charge of the fire party or a designated on-scene team, reporting status back to the master on the bridge.



Communicate the Plan

In a crisis, the crew needs to hear the plan, not just see action — brief the situation and intended actions clearly and repeatedly as it develops.

Notification & Escalation Chain

Every serious emergency triggers the same basic notification sequence, adapted to the specific event.

Step	Action	Responsible
1	Assess situation, activate muster list and emergency team	Master
2	Notify Company DPA / emergency response team	Master
3	Notify nearest RCC/MRCC, coast state or flag state as required	Master / Radio Officer
4	Manage on-scene response and report status continuously	Chief Officer / on-scene team

Working With the Company's Emergency Response Team

The master is not alone — the Company's shore-based emergency response team activates in parallel.



Designated Person Ashore (DPA)

The master's direct link to Company senior management, available 24/7 for any safety or emergency matter.



Shore Emergency Response Team

A pre-designated Company team providing technical, legal, media and logistical support during a major incident.



Salvage & Technical Advisors

Specialist advisors the Company can mobilize for grounding, fire, flooding or structural damage scenarios.



Post-Incident Reporting

A structured incident report and investigation feed both the flag state process and the Company's own SMS review.



SECTION 5

Leadership & Mentoring Junior Officers

Building the bridge and deck team you rely on today, and the officers who will hold your position tomorrow.

05

Leadership Beyond Command Authority

Formal authority gets orders followed; leadership gets a team that performs well when no one is watching.

- Effective senior officers build psychological safety on the bridge and deck — a junior officer must feel able to speak up without fear of ridicule or reprisal.
- Delegating real responsibility, with appropriate oversight, is how junior officers actually develop — not by being kept on the simplest tasks indefinitely.
- Constructive, specific feedback — given promptly, not saved for the end of contract appraisal — accelerates a junior officer's development significantly.
- A senior officer's own visible standards — punctuality, preparation, calm under pressure — are absorbed by junior officers far more than any lecture.
- Recognize good performance explicitly and promptly; junior officers remember specific, genuine recognition long after a generic 'well done.'



You Are Always Training Someone

Every watch you stand with a junior officer present is a training opportunity, whether or not it is formally logged as one.

Structured Ways to Develop Junior Officers

Deliberate mentoring habits that fit naturally into the working watch system.



Explain the 'Why'

Share the reasoning behind decisions, not just the decision itself, so junior officers build judgement, not just compliance.



Progressive Responsibility

Gradually increase independent responsibility as competence is demonstrated, with clear criteria for each step.



Debrief After Events

A short, blame-free debrief after a drill, a difficult manoeuvre or an incident consolidates the learning while it is fresh.



Career Guidance

Discuss certification pathways, sea time requirements and areas for improvement during periodic informal conversations.

Mentoring Without Undermining Standards

Good mentoring builds competence without compromising safety or discipline.



Do

- Allow a junior officer to work through a decision before stepping in, where safety allows
- Correct errors privately and constructively, not in front of the whole team
- Set clear expectations and hold junior officers to them consistently
- Make time for questions, even during a busy watch



Don't

- Don't take over a task the moment a junior officer struggles, unless safety requires it
- Don't let inconsistent standards between watches confuse junior officers
- Don't give feedback that is vague or purely critical without a path to improve
- Don't treat mentoring as separate from your normal watchkeeping duties



SECTION 6

External Inspections — PSC, Vetting & Audits

Standing ready for Port State Control, oil major vetting and internal or external SMS audits at any time.

A Ship That Is Always Ready

The most successful inspections are the ones where nothing needed to change beforehand.

- Port State Control (PSC) inspections verify compliance with SOLAS, MARPOL, STCW and other conventions, and can result in deficiencies, detention or banning.
- Vetting inspections, such as SIRE for tankers, assess a much broader operational and management standard, often against oil major expectations beyond regulatory minimums.
- Internal and external ISM/ISPS audits verify that the SMS is actually being followed in practice, not just documented on paper.
- The senior officer's role is to maintain a genuinely inspection-ready standard continuously, not to prepare intensively only before a known inspection.
- How an inspector is received — professionally, transparently, without defensiveness — materially affects the tone and outcome of an inspection.



Always Ready, Not Just Prepared

An inspection-ready ship is simply a well-run ship — if standards are maintained daily, no special 'inspection mode' should ever be needed.

TYPES OF EXTERNAL INSPECTION

What Each Inspection Actually Checks

Understanding what each inspection type looks for helps focus preparation appropriately.

Inspection	Typical Focus	Possible Outcome
Port State Control (PSC)	Statutory/class certificate compliance, crew competence, equipment condition	Deficiency, detention, banning
Vetting (e.g. SIRE, CDI)	Operational standards, management systems, often beyond regulatory minimums	Observations affecting charterer acceptance
Internal ISM/ISPS Audit	Whether the SMS is followed in day-to-day practice	Non-conformity, corrective action
Flag State / Class Survey	Statutory and class certificate renewal and condition of the vessel	Certificate renewal, conditions of class

What Senior Officers Keep Current

A handful of areas consistently drive inspection outcomes, positive or negative.



Certificates & Documentation

All statutory certificates, surveys and SMS records current, complete and readily retrievable.



Crew Familiarity

Crew able to demonstrate — not just describe — emergency procedures, equipment operation and their own duties.



Housekeeping & Maintenance

Visible general condition, deck and engine room housekeeping, and an up-to-date planned maintenance system.



Open, Professional Engagement

Providing inspectors requested access and information promptly and professionally, without obstruction.



SECTION 7

SMS & Regulatory Compliance Refresher

Refreshing the senior officer's personal accountability for the ISM Code and the Company's Safety Management System.

07

The Master's Responsibility Under the ISM Code

The ISM Code places specific, non-transferable responsibilities directly on the master.

- The ISM Code requires the master to implement the SMS, motivate the crew in observing it, and issue appropriate orders and instructions in a clear and simple manner.
- The master verifies that specified requirements are observed and periodically reviews the SMS, reporting deficiencies to the Company's shore management.
- The chief officer and other senior officers share responsibility for ensuring department-level procedures within the SMS are actually followed, not just filed.
- Non-conformities identified internally should be treated as seriously as those found by an external auditor — early correction avoids repeat findings.
- Regulatory frameworks — SOLAS, MARPOL, STCW, ISPS — are refreshed regularly by the Company, and senior officers are expected to stay current on amendments affecting their vessel type.



Know the Amendments

Regulations change — recent SOLAS, MARPOL and STCW amendments affecting your vessel type should be part of your regular professional reading, not a surprise at the next audit.

THE SMS CYCLE

How the SMS Actually Improves

The Company's SMS is designed as a continuous cycle, not a static set of procedures.

Plan

Procedures and standing orders set the expected way of working across the fleet

Do

The ship applies procedures in daily operations, generating records and reports

Review

Audits, non-conformities and near misses are reviewed to improve procedures fleet-wide

Making Compliance Genuine, Not Just Documented

The difference between real compliance and paper compliance is visible the moment something goes wrong.



Do

- Treat every SMS procedure as something to actually follow, not merely file evidence of
- Raise a non-conformity yourself the moment you find one, rather than waiting for an audit
- Keep your own certificates, endorsements and required refresher training current
- Discuss SMS changes and amendments with your department during routine meetings



Don't

- Don't treat an internal audit as an adversarial event rather than a genuine improvement opportunity
- Don't allow a 'we've always done it this way' habit to override an updated procedure
- Don't sign off on a procedure that was not actually followed as described
- Don't wait for the DPA to raise an issue you already know about



COURSE COMPLETE

Command is a standard you set every watch, every cargo operation and every decision — never delegate the judgement that makes you the senior officer.

Company DPA — 24/7 emergency line

Fleet Operations Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr

Fleet Safety Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr